

SKILLS FOR PROFESSIONAL FREELANCERS

Activity

Ice-breaker



Track Overview

Course	Duration	Delivery Method
1. Career Planning and Introduction to Freelancing	3 hours	Online live
2. Customer Excellence & EI	3 hours	Online live
3. Personal Branding & Networking	3 hours	Online live
4. Virtual Presentation Skills	3 hours	Online live
5. CV Writing & Interviewing Skills	3 hours	Online live
6. Employment Coaching	3 hours	Physical

Pre-assessment



10
Minutes

First Topic

CAREER PLANNING



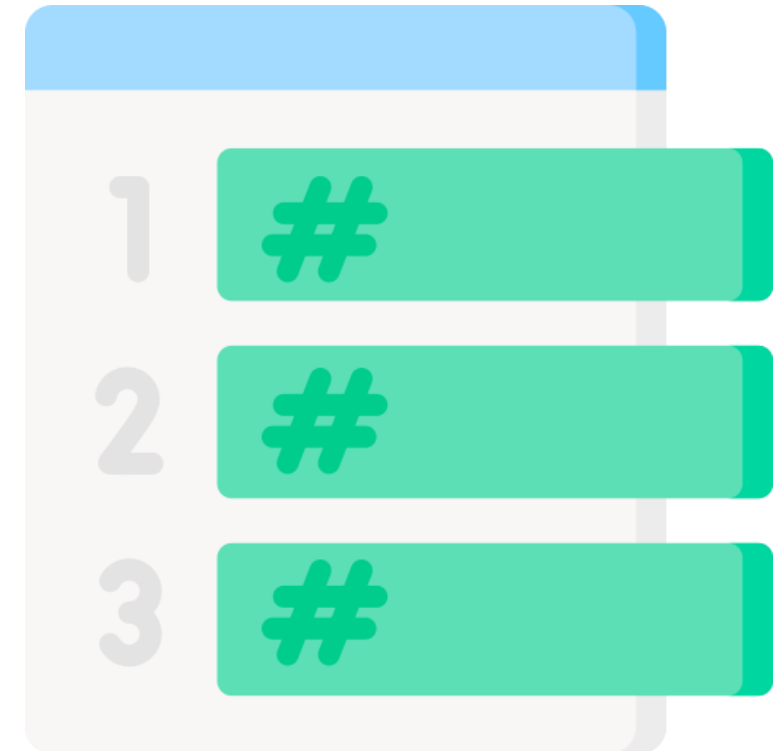
Session Learning Objective:

By the end of this session, participants will learn how to:

- 1 Define career planning and identify the main parts of the Career Diamond.
- 2 Describe how interests, values, personality, and market awareness influence career choices.
- 3 Compare employment, freelancing, and remote work options using personal and market criteria.
- 4 Use AI-supported prompts to identify one target role and one priority skill gap from job information.
- 5 Build a 30-day SMART career action plan aligned with the selected target role.

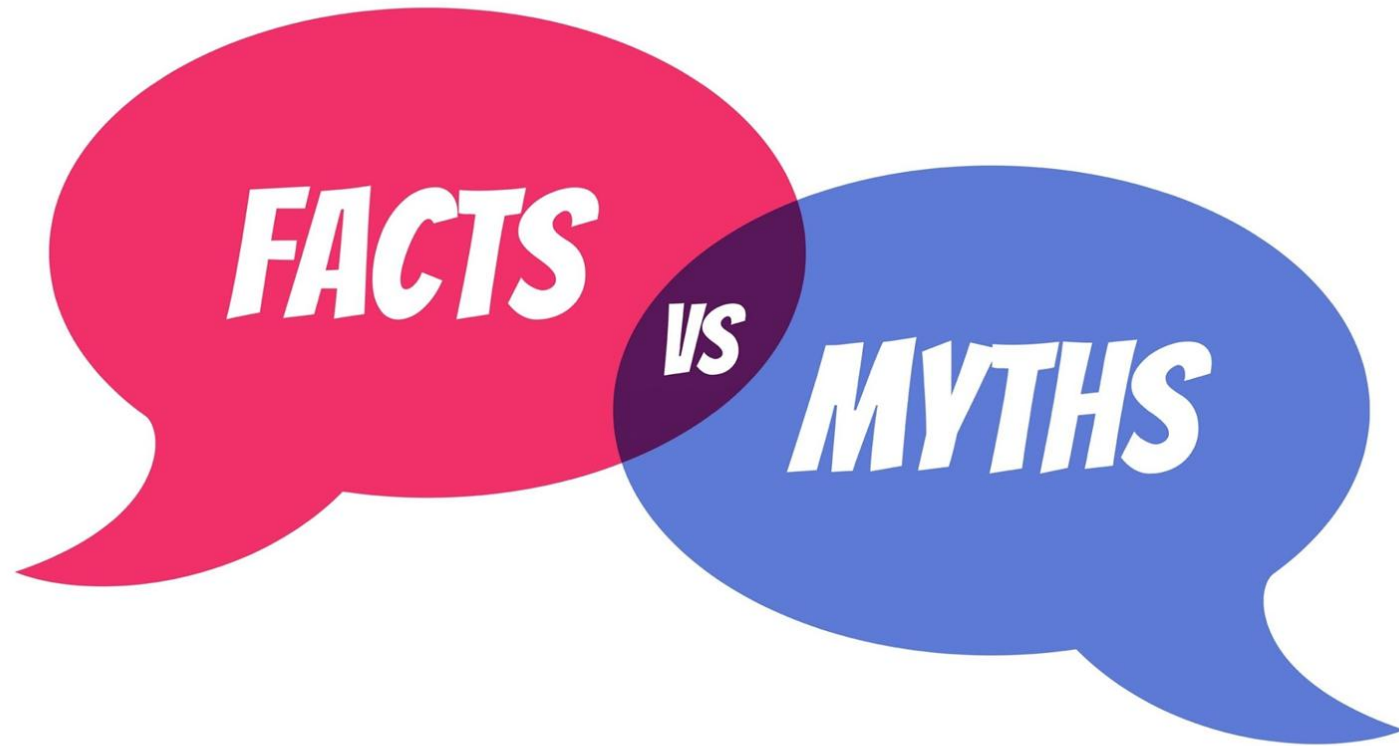
Key topics covered:

- Module 1 – Introduction to Career Planning
- Module 2 – Career Planning Model
- AI Practice 1: Career Fit & Skill Gap
- Module 3 – Your Career Action Plan
- AI Practice 2: 30-Day Career Plan



Module 1: Introduction to Career Planning





The most academically / technically qualified always gets the job



There is only one career that fits me



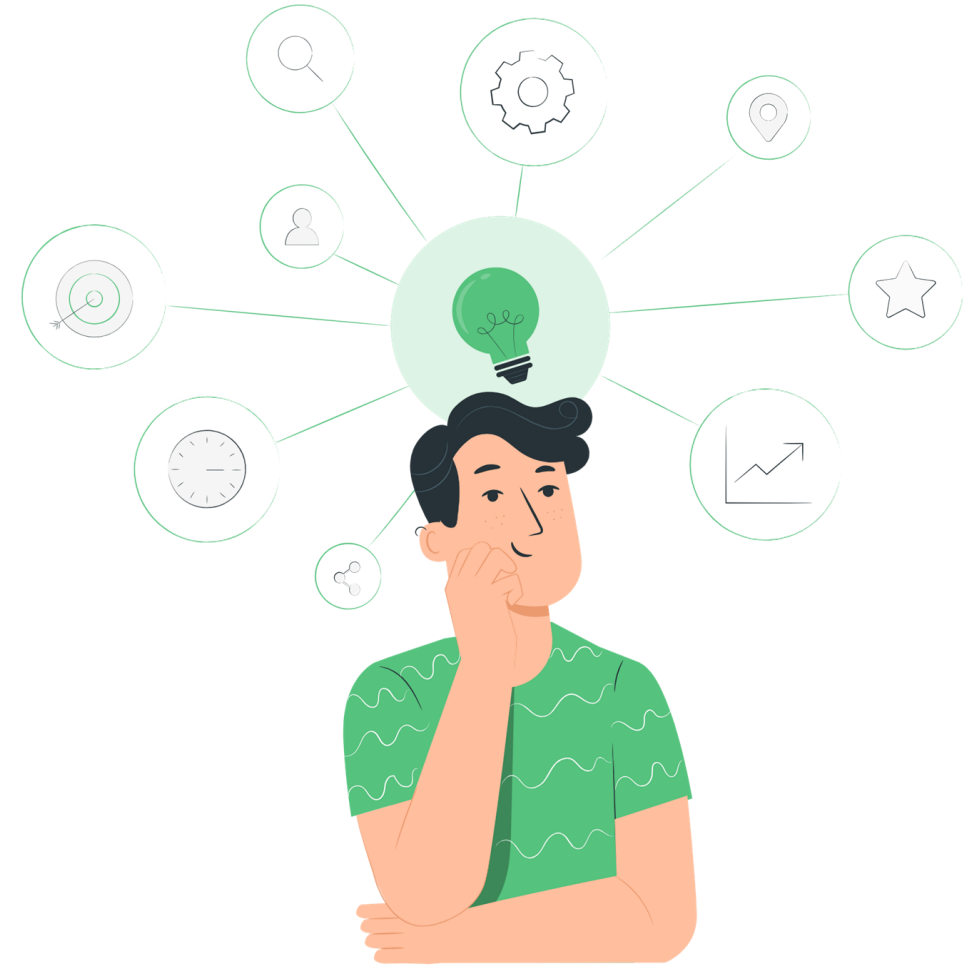
If I am successful, then I am satisfied



Career Planning

Career planning is the process one goes through to decide and pursue their desired career path.

This is based on some aspects that include personal traits, interests, values and market awareness.



Career Planning

Career planning is a process for:

- Identifying what you are good at
- Knowing how your skills, talents, values, and interests translate into possible jobs or careers
- Matching your skills to existing jobs or careers
- Matching your career goals to your financial needs

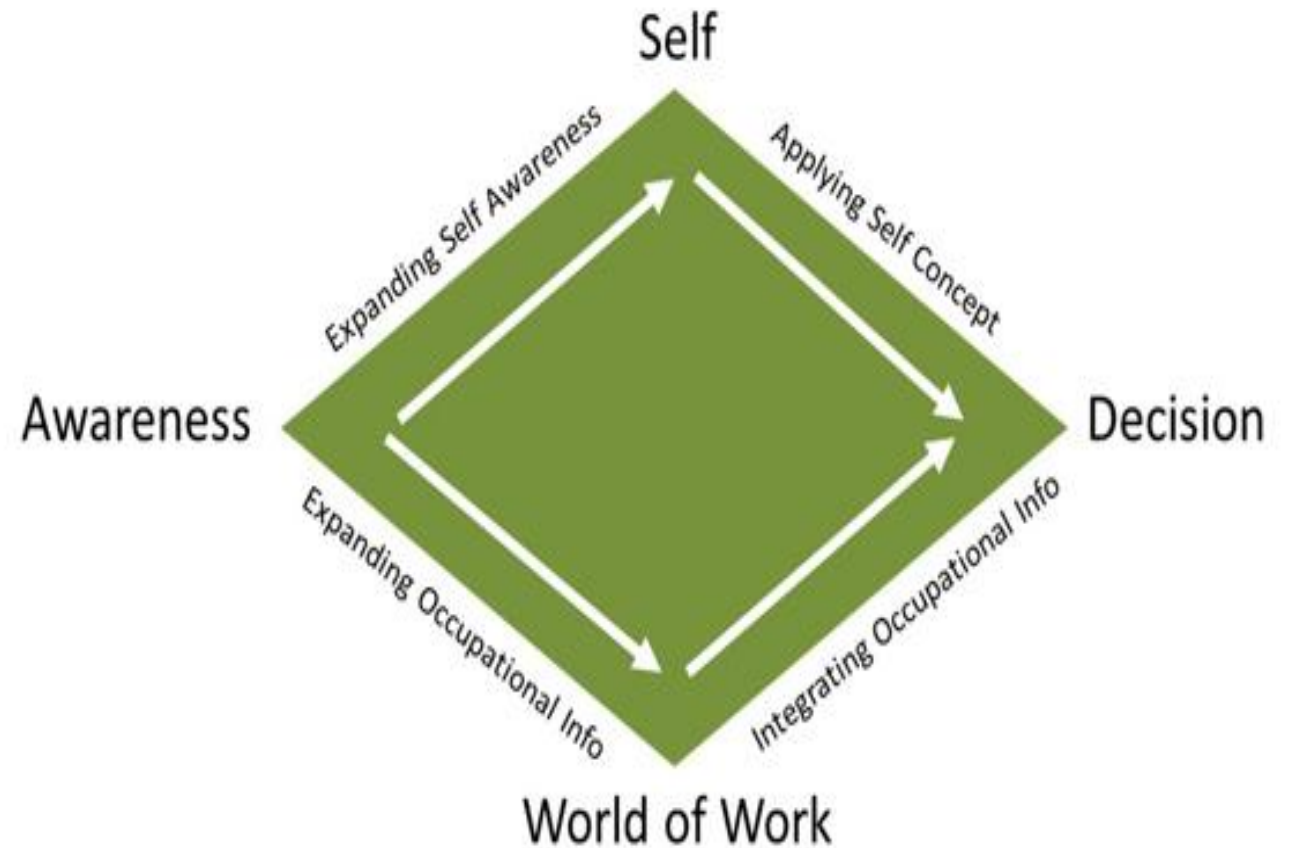
Module 2: Career Planning Model



The Career Diamond

The Career Diamond places the **Self** on top of the diagram, representing the person in charge of managing career issues.

The **World of Work** is placed along the bottom representing the external factors influencing career choices.



Self Awareness



Self-Awareness

- Interests
- Values
- Personality



Self-assessment

Self-Assessment and Career Aptitude Tests

Individuals possess unique skills that can enhance their career prospects.

Self-assessment and aptitude tests can help identify these talents and their compatibility with suitable careers. RIASEC test can help you, scan this QR code and take the test:

RIASEC QUICK CHECK



Values

Deeply held convictions and principles that shape one's choices and actions, reflecting what they consider meaningful and right. They provide a moral compass for decision-making and behaviour.



Travel or Not?

Your dream is to travel and learn abroad, but your family doesn't want you to leave them ? What will you do ?

Independence

Adventure and Exploration

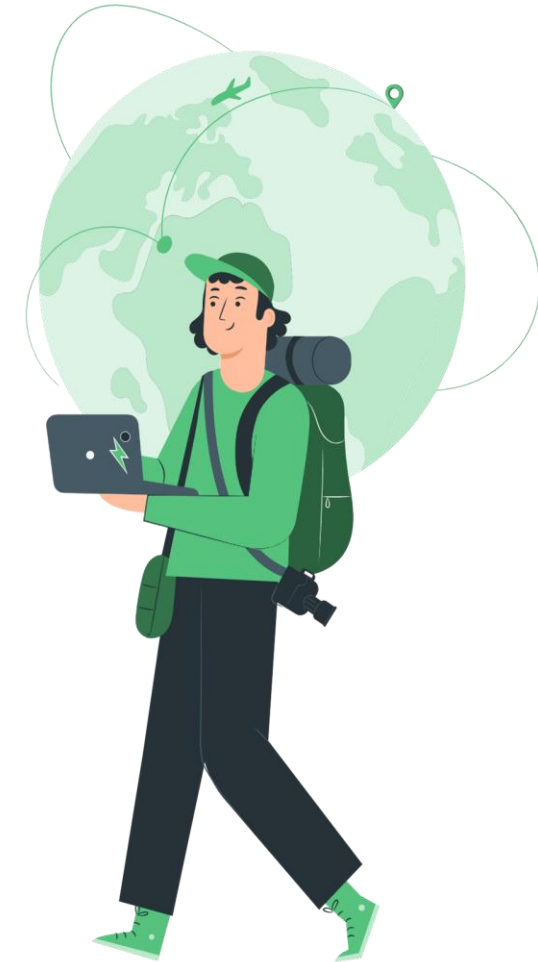
Family

Safety and Security

Passion

Responsibility

Stability



Salary (Money)

Family

Career Ambition

Work life balance

Health and Well-being

Financial Security

"A job demands excessive hours, leaving me with little time for my family with very attractive salary."



Commitment

Friends

Flexibility

Happiness

Fun

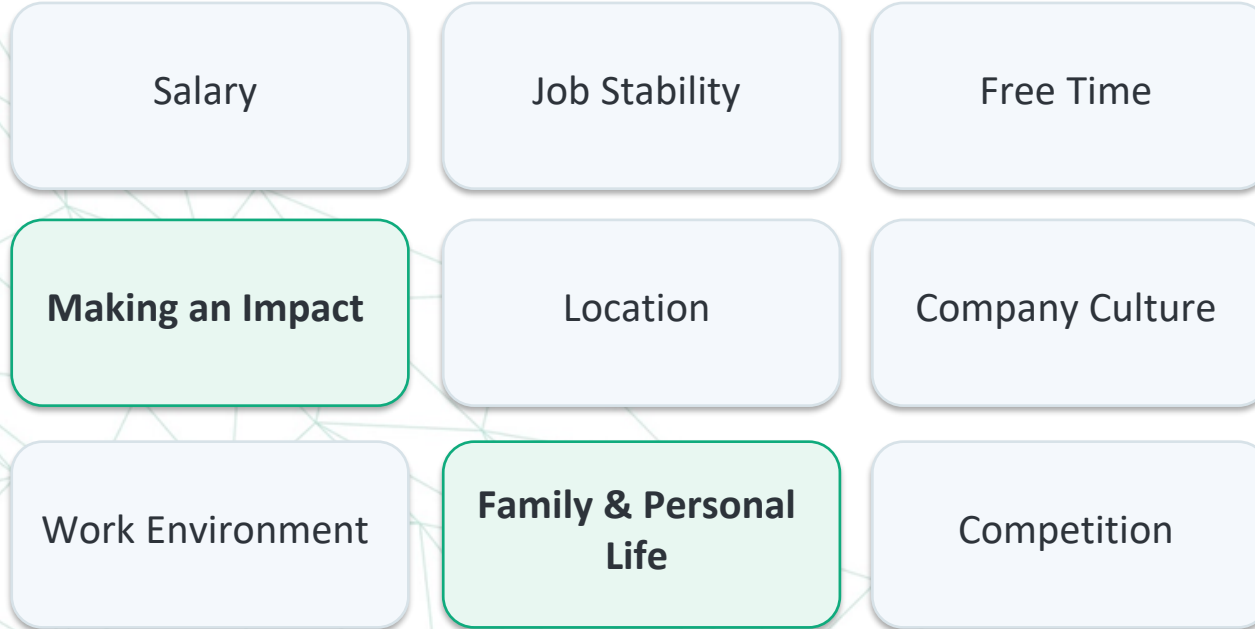
Persistence



“You have an exam in a couple of days and there is a school reunion today”

Prioritize Career Values

Start with the full list



**Values
Assessment**

Quiz

10 questions

5 minutes



Examples of Skills for Job Profiles



Sample Skills Digital Arts Professional



The Career Diamond

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World of Work

- Freelancing career
- Full time job
- Both



Benefits of Freelancing

01



Flexible hours

02



Self-management

03



Location flexibility

04



Global brand exposure

05



Professional networks

06



Earnings control

07



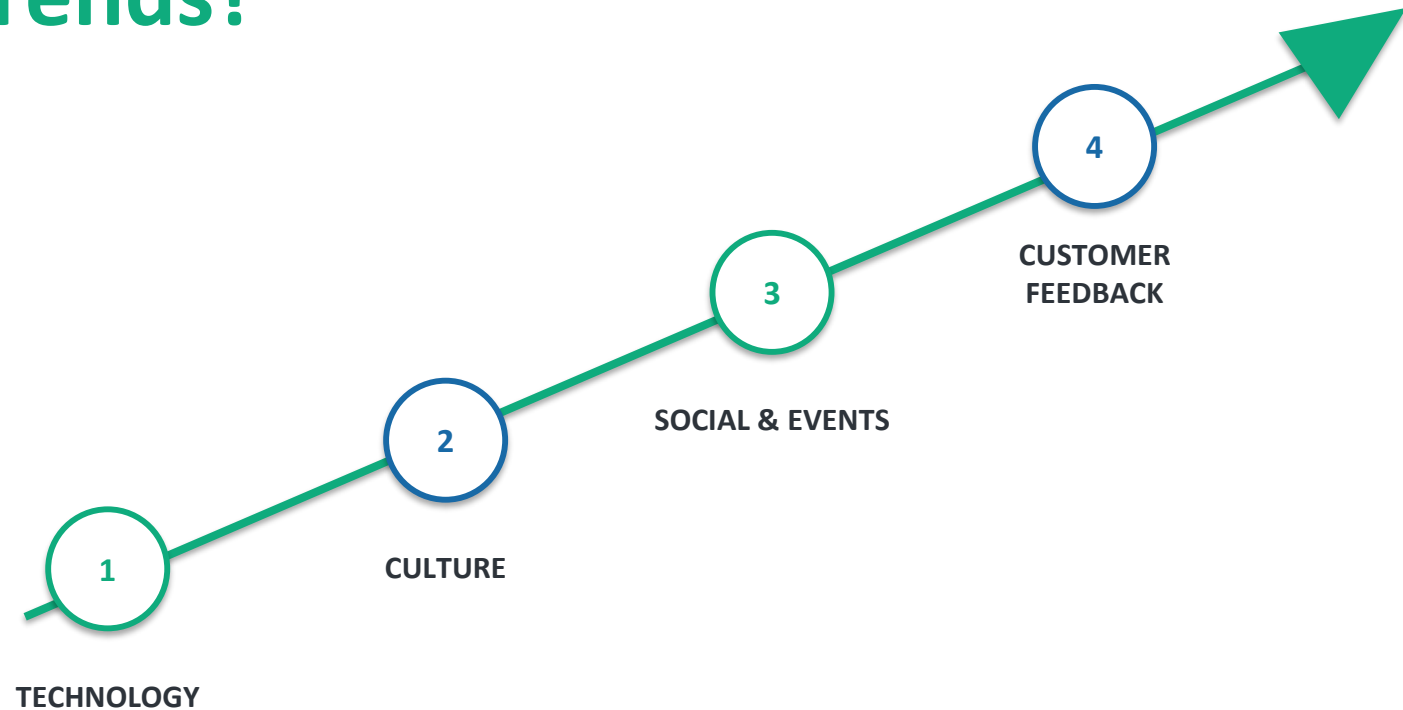
Test a business idea

What are Emerging trends?

DEFINITION

Patterns, behaviors, or preferences that are gaining influence in an industry, niche, or audience.

They matter when they change what clients need or how work gets done.



Ask: What is changing—and what new skills does it create demand for?

What are Emerging trends?

59%

plan to use more remote freelancers
in the upcoming months

60%

plan to do so
in the next two years

upwork

What are Emerging trends?



Freelancers report a surge in demand for their services, indicating a growing preference for flexible, project-based work arrangements.



This aligns with the concept of the gig economy, where temporary or freelance jobs are increasingly common.



A 2017 study cited by Synchrony Bank states that 71% of freelance workers reported finding work online in increasing amounts.



What are Market Demands?

Based on the mentioned market trends and freelancer observations, here are some skills you might consider improving to meet the evolving requirements of the labor market:

Adaptability & Continuous Learning

Digital Proficiency

Effective Self-Management & Time Management

Communication & Interpersonal Skills

Business & Entrepreneurship

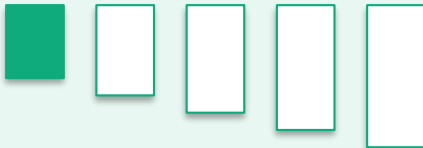
Market Demands?

WHY IT MATTERS

01

Adaptability & Continuous Learning

CORE CAPABILITY



Specialized work changes quickly, so sustained employability depends on learning and adjusting.

BUILD IT BY

- ✓ Adopt a growth mindset.
- ✓ Learn skills that are relevant to your field.
- ✓ Use courses, workshops, and deliberate practice.

Market Demands?

WHY IT MATTERS

02

Digital Proficiency

CORE CAPABILITY



Digital tools and online collaboration increasingly shape how work is delivered across industries.

BUILD IT BY

- ✓ Master the tools used in your field.
- ✓ Strengthen online communication and collaboration.
- ✓ Track emerging technologies and their impact.

Market Demands?

WHY IT MATTERS

03

Self-Management & Time Management

CORE CAPABILITY



Flexible work increases the need to prioritize, organize, and deliver without constant supervision.

BUILD IT BY

- ✓ Prioritize tasks and deadlines.
- ✓ Organize your workload and schedule.
- ✓ Build a focused routine and workspace.

Market Demands?

WHY IT MATTERS

Clear communication and strong relationships help freelancers and employees earn trust and retain opportunities.

BUILD IT BY

- ✓ Present your value clearly.
- ✓ Listen actively for client or employer needs.
- ✓ Network with purpose.

04

Communication &
Interpersonal Skills

CORE CAPABILITY



Market Demands?

WHY IT MATTERS

05

Business & Entrepreneurship

CORE CAPABILITY



Freelancers operate like small businesses and need basic commercial, financial, and contractual awareness.

BUILD IT BY



Learn basic marketing and sales.



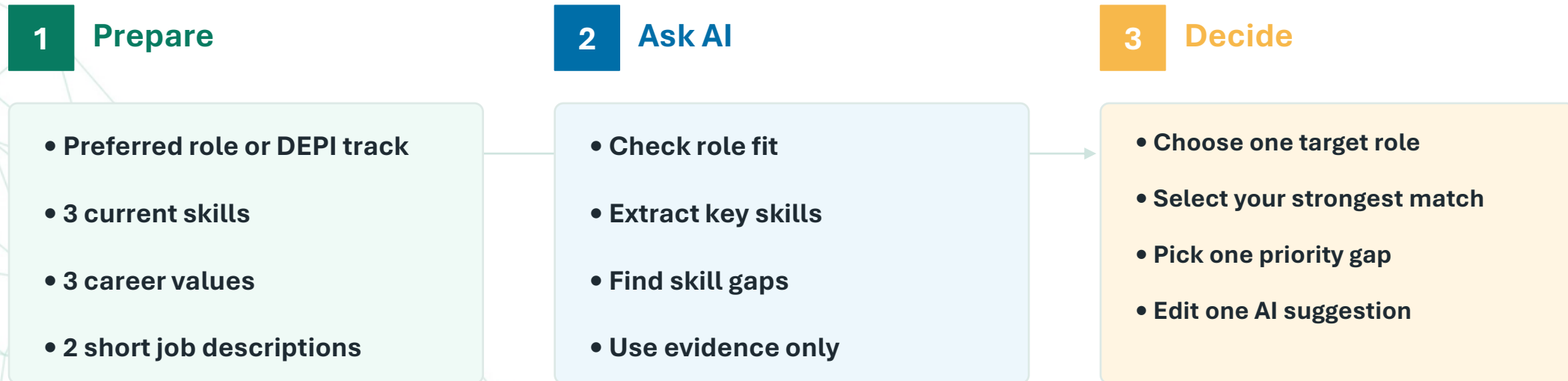
Track income and expenses.



Understand contracts and fair terms.

Activity 1 - AI Career Fit Check

Use AI to connect your profile with market requirements — then make your own decision.



Expected output: one target role + one priority skill gap

Prompt + Decision Card

Prompt

Based only on the information provided, identify one target role that may fit me, five key skills required for this role, and my top three skill gaps. Explain your answer using evidence from the two job descriptions. Do not assume information I did not provide.

Decision Card

Target role

Strongest matching skill

Priority skill gap

One AI suggestion I edited

Emerging Markets

WHY IT MATTERS

01

Stay Informed

PRACTICAL MOVE

Fast-moving markets require current information before you make career or business decisions.

PRACTICAL MOVES

- ✓ Follow reliable economic and industry data.
- ✓ Compare several trusted sources.
- ✓ Track changes that affect your target roles.

Emerging Markets

WHY IT MATTERS

02

Develop Market-Specific Expertise

PRACTICAL MOVE

Understanding local demand, regulations, and industry context improves the quality of your decisions.

PRACTICAL MOVES

- ✓ Read industry and government reports.
- ✓ Learn local regulations and demand.
- ✓ Speak with people who know the market.

Emerging Markets

WHY IT MATTERS

Plans must adapt as the landscape evolves and unexpected challenges appear.

PRACTICAL MOVES

- ✓ Test ideas in small steps.
- ✓ Review assumptions often.
- ✓ Build change-management and agility skills.

03

**Embrace Flexibility &
Agility**

PRACTICAL MOVE

Emerging Markets

WHY IT MATTERS

04

Prioritize Cultural Sensitivity

PRACTICAL MOVE

Trust grows when you understand local norms and adapt how you communicate and collaborate.

PRACTICAL MOVES

- ✓ Learn local norms and expectations.
- ✓ Adapt your communication style.
- ✓ Ask before assuming.

Emerging Markets

WHY IT MATTERS

05

Invest in Building Relationships

PRACTICAL MOVE

Local partners, stakeholders, and professional networks provide context, support, and opportunity.

PRACTICAL MOVES

- ✓ Attend relevant events.
- ✓ Join local business networks.
- ✓ Build trusted local partnerships.

Module 3: Your Career Action Plan



SMART Goals

S

SPECIFIC

What exactly will you accomplish?

M

MEASURABLE

What evidence will show progress?

A

ACHIEVABLE

Is it realistic with your current time and resources?

R

RELEVANT

How does it support your target role?

T

TIME-BOUND

What is the deadline or review date?

Free Tools To Help You Write and Track SMART Goals



Activity 2 - Build a 30-Day SMART Career Plan

Prompt to use

Create a realistic 30-day SMART plan to improve [skill] for [target role]. I can spend [X] hours per week. Divide it into four weeks. Each week must include one learning task, one practical task, one measurable output, and one checkpoint.

Use the same prompt in both DEPI versions; change the role and job evidence according to the track.

30-Day Plan Template

Week	Learning task	Practice task	Evidence
Week 1			
Week 2			
Week 3			
Week 4			

Review before you submit:

Is it realistic? • Is progress measurable? • What did I edit in the AI plan?

Let's Recap

Now we know how to:

- ✓ Define career planning and the Career Diamond
- ✓ Connect strengths, values, and work options
- ✓ Compare freelancing, remote work, and full-time paths
- ✓ Use AI to scan role fit and identify one skill gap
- ✓ Build a 30-day SMART career action plan



Q&A Session



Thank You!

Thank you for your participation
and attention!

